
A routine you can sustain

FOUR SESSIONS PER WEEK

Session A: 25 minutes learning one branch and 10 minutes reconstructing it. Session B: 20 minutes solving exercises and 15 minutes playing a diagram. Session C: one slow game. Session D: 30-45 minutes reviewing that game.

USE SPACED RECALL

Review a new branch the next day, after three days and after a week. Once it becomes reliable, review it less often and spend more time on the positions where you still choose a plan incorrectly.

KEEP A SMALL PERSONAL NOTEBOOK

Record the White trigger, your chosen reply, the reason, a danger and the booklet line ID. Add your own game after the opening line. Do not accumulate long engine variations without a practical question.

STUDY THE MAIN PATH FIRST

Booklet 15 is an optional second Fianchetto repertoire. Learn Booklet 14 first. Learn the companion defenses in 18-20 as distinct positions, rather than forcing a KID setup into them.

Weeks 1-4

WEEK 1 / ORIENTATION AND MOVE ORDERS

Read 00, 01, 20. Learn the basic setup and the points where you choose a companion defense. Reconstruct the board from Black's side without reversing square names.

WEEK 2 / CLASSICAL GATEWAY AND EXCHANGES

Read 02, 06. Practice d5, dxe5 and continued tension as three different central decisions. Play four training games from the gateway position.

WEEK 3 / MAR DEL PLATA PLANS

Read 03, 21. Learn the knight routes and ...f5 conditions. In each training game, count White's c5 timing before pushing another kingside pawn.

WEEK 4 / BAYONET AND OTHER NINTH MOVES

Read 04, 05. Practice 9.b4 separately from 9.Ne1. Solve the central ...e4 intermezzo and explain the g7 bishop's role.

Weeks 5-8

WEEK 5 / PETROSIAN AND GLIGORIC

Read 07, 08. Explain why the early bishop and delayed castling change the plans. Reconstruct one main line and one White deviation for each.

WEEK 6 / SAMISCH PANNO

Read 09, 10. Practice d5, a4, long castling, h4 and g4 as different triggers. Count forcing moves on both wings.

WEEK 7 / FOUR PAWNS AND AVERBAKH

Read 11, 12. Learn the ...c5/...e6 transition and the e5 threat. Compare the f4 and f2 pawn positions before using a tactical idea.

WEEK 8 / MAKOGONOV AND EARLY PIECE CHOICES

Read 13, 16. Play against h3, Bg5, Nge2 and Bd3. Identify White's king plan before deciding the direction of your attack.

Weeks 9-12

WEEK 9 / FIANCHETTO CORE

Read 14. Study the central ...Nbd7/...e5 plan. Compare the positions with your earlier White 1.d4 course. Leave optional Booklet 15 until the core is secure.

WEEK 10 / QUIET SYSTEMS AND COMPANION DEFENSES

Read 17, 18, 19. Practice the moment White omits d4, c4 or e4. Explain why an English or London position needs a different central plan.

WEEK 11 / MIDDLEGAME DECISIONS

Read 21, 22, 23. Play both colors from three laboratory positions. Annotate the first divergence and one missed defensive resource.

WEEK 12 / ASSESSMENT AND CONSOLIDATION

Read 24, 25; optional 15. Take the exercise assessment in three sessions. Repair weak branches in the notebook, then play six slow games using the whole repertoire.

Reference card: your first decisions

CLASSICAL

Nf3 and Be2: ...e5. After O-O: ...Nc6. After d5: ...Ne7. Then distinguish Ne1, b4, Nd2 and Bd2. Do not guess White's ninth move.

OTHER CENTRAL SYSTEMS

f3: Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8. f4: ...c5/...e6. Be2/Bg5: ...c5/...e6. h3: keep the king choice in view and use ...e5/...Na6 plans.

FIANCHETTO

Use ...Nbd7, ...e5 and a central plan. The usual pawn storm is not automatic. Compare ...c6, ...exd4 and ...Nc5.

COMPANION DEFENSES

2.Bg5: ...Ne4. 2.Nc3: ...d5. London/Torre/Colle: challenge d4 and the coming e4 break. English/Reti: transpose only when the center actually matches.

BEFORE EVERY MOVE

Checks, captures, threats. Then the center, king safety and worst piece. Calculate White's strongest forcing reply before committing to a plan.

Your post-game review form

GAME DETAILS

Date: _____ Opponent: _____ Time control: _____

Result: _____ Booklet / line ID: _____

FIRST UNFAMILIAR DECISION

Move number: _____ White's threat: _____

My candidates: _____

What I played and why: _____

POSITION ASSESSMENT

Center: locked / fluid / open. Relevant pawn break: _____

Black's worst piece: _____ White's best resource: _____

Was a trade or defensive move necessary? _____

ONE REPAIR

Better plan or calculation: _____

One notebook change: _____

Review dates: tomorrow _____ three days _____ one week _____